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Principles of Information Visualization

Assignment 1

✔ Reading: Graphics Lies, Misleading Visuals13 min

🕒 Peer-graded Assignment: Graphics Lies, Misleading VisualsGrading in progress

👤 Review Your Peers: Graphics Lies, Misleading Visuals

Peer-graded Assignment: Graphics Lies, Misleading Visuals

Reviews 2 left to complete

ⓘ

It looks like this is your first peer-graded assignment. [Learn more](#)

✕

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Lies in Labour InfoGraphics

NJ by Neha JhambSeptember 19, 2024

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PROMPT

Read Alberto Cairo's work, [Graphics Lies, Misleading Visuals](#)

Locate an example of a misleading visual that uses one or more of the mechanisms for misleading that Cairo outlines in his book chapter: (1) Hiding relevant data; (2) Displaying too much data and obscuring reality; (3) Distorting data through visual forms.

Please upload an image of this visual using a widely accessible graphic format (e.g., PDF, .jpg, .png)

Lies hidden in the Labour Force Data Visualization

The visual tends to show the comparison of the Female labor force in India as compared to China and the World

RUBRIC

Has the learner uploaded a visual?

☐ 0 pts

No

☐ 1 pt

Yes

PROMPT

Briefly describe the context for the visual by addressing the following questions:

1. What is the source of the visual? (e.g., URL or bibliographic citation)

2. Who is the intended audience (i.e., decoders)? How do you know this?

1. Source of the visual is the Youtube channel: Bloomberg originals (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KhFUSBzeDw&t=178s)

2. Intended audience: The news watchers on youtube - mostly the young Indians (as can be seen from the comments below the video) but other around the world, mostly comprising of people aged between 18-50 years of age (these are rough estimates).

RUBRIC

Did the learner provide the source of the visual?

☐ 0 pts

No

☐ 1 pt

Yes

Did the learner identify the intended audience? Did they provide an explanation of how they know who the intended audience is?

☐ 0 pts

The learner did not identify the intended audience.

☐ 2 pts

The learner identified the intended audience, but did not provide an explanation.

☐ 4 pts

The learner identified the intended audience and they provided an explanation of how they knew who the intended audience is.

PROMPT

1. Identify the specific component(s) of the visual that is/are misleading

2. For each part(s) of the visualization that is/are misleading, identify the mechanism that is used: hiding relevant data to highlight what benefits us; displaying too much data to obscure reality; using graphic forms in inappropriate ways (distorting the data)

3. Explain how the mechanisms are used to mislead

1. Notice that while comparing the female labor force, the data is shown for China, the world and India. While China is a developed country, the comparison with India (developing country) is not justifiable. On top of that, showing the female labour participation for the world as one separate bar doesn't really depict the clear picture for other countries.

2. Mechanisms:

a. Comparison of India's female labor force with China's female labor force can be categorised as **distortion of data**.

b. Showing a bar called World and comparing it with India and China can be categorized as **hiding relevant data**. There is no explanation as to what is hidden under the bar called "World" which causes ambiguity.

3. Explanation as to how these mechanisms are used to mislead:

a. Distortion of data: Showing just 3 bars to compare the female labour force participation across the world shows that the objective of the infographic is not to educate people but to prove the claim made that India's female labour force is one of the lowest in the world (as can be seen from the subtitle on the screenshot*).

b. Hiding relevant data: If the data were shown for competing economies such as India in the world, and then this data was used to prove the news channel's claim, it would have been more credible.

*Note that the screenshot has been taken directly from the youtube video

RUBRIC

Did the learner identify one or more specific components that is/are misleading?

☐ 0 pts

No

☐ 3 pts

Yes

For each component of the visual that the learner identified as misleading, did the learner identify the mechanism that was used to mislead?

☐ 0 pts

No

☐ 3 pts

Yes

Did the learner explain how the mechanisms were used to mislead?

☐ 0 pts

No

☐ 3 pts

Yes

PROMPT

Optional: Describe any additional issues you found with visual that did not fall under Cairo's three misleading mechanisms.

This is a personal thought on the infographic - the red color could have been used to show the lowest labor force participation % rather than the highest one (China as per this visual) as red generally depicts the negative or unwanted outcomes. It would also have helped to make the point better had the information been shown in the truest form.

RUBRIC

Optional: If the learner described additional issues and you would like to provide feedback on their comments, please do so here.

Minimum 100 characters: 0

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Comments

Comments left for the learner are visible only to that learner and the person who left the comment.

SD

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